

Promises and Pressure: The Bridge Forward

承诺与压力：通向下一程

Theme: 友谊、家庭与人际关系 · New: 45 · Review: 18 · Planned cumulative progress: 45/6,127

English Story

The third arc closed with a **lunch** that was supposed to be a **victory**. The transferred project had continued for six weeks without Lin; the **participant** numbers were **abundant**, and **every** volunteer had stayed. “**Nobody** expected that,” the **spokeswoman** said. Her **joy** was real, and so was her **insistence** that the report mention the **last setback**. **Suddenly** there was an **incentive** to do what **nobody** had asked: **part** of the money was for the **ongoing** work, and **any** of the **million** small tasks could now be paid. **Each** of them had an **eye** on the door, and **no** one sat still.

He was not **triumphant**. Sitting in his **overcoat**, he watched the rain and felt an **ache** in his **thumb** from carrying boxes. “We invested a year,” he said. “**Some** of it was a **triumph**. **Most** of it was not.” A **few** of the guests agreed; **several** did not.

A **jealous** colleague, a **drunk** broker, and a **defiant** young man from the **hut** settlement all spoke at the **luncheon**. “**Nowadays** everybody wants a **conqueror**,” the broker said. “You want a **blackboard**.” The **relevance** of the remark was not obvious to anyone, **least** of all to him.

The **frustrating part** was the **handwriting** on the report: his own. **Oftentimes** the **least influential** person in the room writes the document that sways the room, and he had written it without noticing which side he was on. “Do not **continue** out of **laziness**,” Maya said. “**Continue** out of **impulse**, if you must, but keep the **shelter** open, and do not raise a **fist** at the people who read it.”

Several participants disapproved of the final paragraph. A **hat** and a **glove** were, **quite** simply, not a policy, and the **insistent** demand for a cleaner number could not be met without deleting somebody's name. **Many** of them would **persevere**; **some** would not. “The **interviewee** is not the **interviewee** of the **question**,” the **spokeswoman** said. “That is why we keep asking.” The **question**, at **least**, had survived the **defeat**, and there was **no** shame in that. “**Shit**,” the broker said, when the final total appeared on the screen; he was **immensely** relieved, and he said so, twice. The promise had survived the pressure, and the price of it had a name in **every** room they entered.

中文翻译

第三段弧线以一顿本该算是胜利的午餐收尾。移交出去的项目在没有林伟的情况下继续了六周；参与者数量充足，每位志愿者都留了下来。“没人料到会这样，”女发言人说。她的喜悦是真实的，她坚持要在报告里提到最近那次挫折也是真实的。突然间出现了一种动机，去做没人要求过的事：一部分钱是给这项持续工作的，那一百万件小事中的任何一件现在都能拿到报酬。每个人眼睛都盯着门口，没有人安稳坐着。

他并不得意。穿着外套坐着，他看着雨，感到拇指因搬箱子而隐隐作痛。“我们投入了一年，”他说，“其中一部分是凯旋，大部分不是。”有几位客人同意，有几位不同意。

一位心怀嫉妒的同事、一个醉酒的经纪人，以及一个来自小屋聚落的挑衅青年，都在午宴上发了言。“如今人人都想要征服者，”经纪人说，“而你们想要的是一块黑板。”这句话的相关性对谁都不明显，对他尤其如此。

令人沮丧的是报告上的笔迹：他自己的。常常是屋里最没有影响力的人写下那份左右全屋的文件，而他写下它时并没有留意自己站在哪一边。“不要因为懒惰才继续下去，”曼雅说，“如果非要继续，那就凭着冲动继续，但要让庇护所开着，也不要对读它的人举起拳头。”

好几位参与者不赞成最后一段。一顶帽子和一只手套，说白了，不是政策；而要满足那坚持要一个更干净数字的要求，就得删掉某个人的名字。他们中很多人会坚持下去，有些人不会。“被采访者不是问题的被采访者，”女发言人说，“所以我们才要一直问。”至少那个问题在失败中活了下来，而这并不丢人。“见鬼，”当最终数字出现在屏幕上时，经纪人说；他如释重负，而且他说了两遍。那个承诺在压力中活了下来，而它的代价，在他们走进的每一个房间里都有一个名字。

Core Vocabulary · 核心词汇

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
suddenly 'sʌdənlɪ POS: adv	adv. 突然, 意外, 忽然, 迅速, 即席作成, 即刻, 急速 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. happening unexpectedly
participant pɑ:'tɪsɪpənt POS: n	n. 参加者, 参与者; a. 有份的, 参加的, 参与的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. someone who takes part in an activity
nobody 'neɪbɒdi POS: n	n. 小人物, 无名小卒; pron. 无人, 没有人 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n a person of no influence
victory 'vɪktəri POS: n	n. 胜利, 战胜, 克服 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a successful ending of a struggle or contest
lunch lʌntʃ POS: n	n. 午餐 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a midday meal; v. take the midday meal; v. provide a midday meal for
invest ɪn'vest POS: vt	vt. 投资, 花费, 笼罩, 授予; vi. 投资, 利用 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. make an investment; v. furnish with power or authority; of kings or emperors; v. provide with power and auth...
hat hæt POS: n	n. 帽子; vt. 给...戴帽子 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. headdress that protects the head from bad weather; has shaped crown and usually a brim; n. an informal term...
defeat dɪ'fi:t POS: n	n. 败北, 失败; vt. 击败, 使落空 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an unsuccessful ending to a struggle or contest
incentive ɪn'sentɪv POS: n	n. 动机; a. 激励的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a positive motivational influence
joy dʒɔɪ POS: n	n. 欢喜, 乐事, 高兴; vt. 使快乐, 令人高兴; vi. 欢喜 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the emotion of great happiness; n. something or someone that provides a source of happiness
shelter 'ʃeltə POS: n	n. 庇护所, 避难所, 庇护, 隐蔽处, 掩蔽; vt. 庇护, 保护, 隐匿; vi. 躲避 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a structure that provides privacy and protection from danger; n. protective covering that provides protecti...
ongoing 'ɒŋɡəʊɪŋ POS: a	a. 前进的, 进行的, 不间断的; n. 前进, 发展 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. currently happening
glove ɡlʌv POS: n	n. 手套; vt. 给...戴手套 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. handwear: covers the hand and wrist
shit ʃɪt POS: vi	vi. 拉屎; vt. 欺骗, 在...拉屎; n. 粪, 屎; interj. 狗屁 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a coarse term for defecation
triumph 'traɪəmf POS: n	n. 凯旋, 胜利, 欢欣; vi. 得胜, 成功 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the exultation of victory
drunk drʌŋk POS: a	a. 喝醉了的; drink的过去式 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. someone who is intoxicated
thumb θʌm POS: n	n. 拇指; vt. 以拇指拨弄, 笨拙地摆弄, 用拇指翻旧, 迅速翻阅, 作搭车手势 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the thick short innermost digit of the forelimb; n. the part of a glove that provides a covering for the th...
influential ,ɪnflu'entʃəl POS: a	a. 有影响的, 有势力的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. having or exercising influence or power
fist fɪst POS: n	n. 拳头, 手; vt. 拳打, 握成拳, 紧握 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a hand with the fingers clenched in the palm (as for hitting)
relevance 'relɪvəns POS: n	n. 中肯; 关联; 相关性 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the relation of something to the matter at hand
nowadays 'naʊədeɪz POS: n	n. 现在, 现时, 当今; adv. 时下, 现今 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. in these times
hut hʌt POS: n	n. 小屋, 茅舍, 临时军营; v. (使)住在茅舍 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. temporary military shelter
impulse 'ɪmpʌls POS: n	n. 冲动, 驱使, 刺激, 推动, 冲力, 建议, 脉冲; vt. 推动 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the act of applying force suddenly
jealous 'dʒeləs POS: a	a. 嫉妒的, 羡慕的, 留心的, 戒备的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. suspicious or unduly suspicious or fearful of being displaced by a rival

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
sway swei POS: n	n. 摇摆, 影响力, 支配; vt. 摇动, 支配, 弄歪, 使倾斜, 使动摇, 影响; vi. 摇动, 摇摆, 倾斜, 动摇, 统治, 转向 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. controlling influence
frustrating frʌ'streɪtɪŋ POS: a	a. 令人沮丧的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. discouraging by hindering; s. preventing realization or attainment of a desire
abundant ə'bʌndənt POS: a	a. 丰富的, 充分的, 大量的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. present in great quantity
spokeswoman 'spəʊks,wʊmən POS: n	n. 女发言人, 女代言人 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a female spokesperson
insistence in'sistəns POS: n	n. 坚持, 坚决主张 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. continual and persistent demands; n. the act of insisting on something
immensely i'mensli POS: adv	adv. 无限地, 广大地, 庞大地 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r to an exceedingly great extent or degree
setback 'setbæk POS: n	n. 挫折, 退步, 逆流 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n an unfortunate happening that hinders or impedes; something that is thwarting or frustrating
ache eɪk POS: n	n. 疼痛; vi. 痛, 哀怜, 渴望 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a dull persistent (usually moderately intense) pain; v. have a desire for something or someone who is not p...
handwriting 'hændraɪtɪŋ POS: n	n. 笔迹 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. something written by hand; n. the activity of writing by hand
disapprove ,dɪsə'pru:v POS: v	v. 不赞成 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. consider bad or wrong; v. deem wrong or inappropriate
triumphant traɪ'ʌmfənt POS: a	a. 得胜的, 得意洋洋的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. experiencing triumph
defiant dɪ'faɪənt POS: a	a. 挑衅的, 目中无人的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. boldly resisting authority or an opposing force
insistent in'sistent POS: a	a. 坚持的, 迫切的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. repetitive and persistent
luncheon 'lʌntʃən POS: n	n. 午宴, 午餐会 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n a midday meal
overcoat 'əʊvəkəʊt POS: n	n. 外套大衣 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an additional protective coating (as of paint or varnish)
conqueror 'kɒŋkərə POS: n	n. 征服者, 胜利者 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. someone who is victorious by force of arms
blackboard 'blækbo:d POS: n	n. 黑板 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. sheet of slate; for writing with chalk
oftentimes 'ɒ:fntaɪnz POS: adv	adv. 时常地 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r many times at short intervals
interviewee ,ɪntəvju:'i: POS: n	n. 被接见者, 被采访者, 被面试者 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person who is interviewed
persevere ,pə'sɪviə POS: vi	vi. 坚持, 孜孜不倦, 不屈不挠, (辩论中)固执己见 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. be persistent, refuse to stop
laziness 'leɪzɪnɪs POS: n	n. 怠惰, 无精打采 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. relaxed and easy activity